

Develop Capabilities

Sub-techniques (4)



Adversaries may build capabilities that can be used during targeting. Rather than purchasing, freely downloading, or stealing capabilities, adversaries may develop their own capabilities in-house. This is the process of identifying development requirements and building solutions such as malware, exploits, and self-signed certificates. Adversaries may develop capabilities to support their operations throughout numerous phases of the adversary lifecycle.^{[1][2][3][4]}

As with legitimate development efforts, different skill sets may be required for developing capabilities. The skills needed may be located in-house, or may need to be contracted out. Use of a contractor may be considered an extension of that adversary's development capabilities, provided the adversary plays a role in shaping requirements and maintains a degree of exclusivity to the capability.

ID: T1587

Sub-techniques: [T1587.001](#), [T1587.002](#), [T1587.003](#), [T1587.004](#)

- ① **Tactic:** [Resource Development](#)
- ① **Platforms:** PRE

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[Version Permalink](#)

Procedure Examples

ID	Name	Description
G1052	Contagious Interview	Contagious Interview developed malicious NPM packages for delivery to or retrieval by victims. ^{[5][6][7][8][9][10][11]}
G0094	Kimsuky	Kimsuky created and used a mailing toolkit to use in spearphishing attacks. ^[12]
G1036	Moonstone Sleet	Moonstone Sleet developed malicious npm packages for delivery to or retrieval by victims. ^[13]

Mitigations

ID	Mitigation	Description
M1056	Pre-compromise	This technique cannot be easily mitigated with preventive controls since it is based on behaviors performed outside of the scope of enterprise defenses and controls.

Detection Strategy

ID	Name	Analytic ID	Analytic Description
DET0853	Detection of Develop Capabilities	AN1985	Consider analyzing malware for features that may be associated with the adversary and/or their developers, such as compiler used, debugging artifacts, or code similarities. Malware repositories can also be used to identify additional samples associated with the adversary and identify development patterns over time. Much of this activity will take place outside the visibility of the target organization, making detection of this behavior difficult. Detection efforts may be focused on related stages of the adversary lifecycle, such as during Defense Evasion or Command and Control. Monitor for contextual data about a malicious payload, such as compilation times, file hashes, as well as watermarks or other identifiable configuration information. Much of this activity will take place outside the visibility of the target organization, making detection of this behavior difficult. Detection efforts may be focused on related stages of the adversary lifecycle, such as during Defense Evasion or Command and Control. Consider use of services that may aid in the tracking of capabilities, such as certificates, in use on sites across the Internet. In some cases it may be possible to pivot on known pieces of information to uncover other adversary infrastructure.^[14] Much of this activity will take place outside the visibility of the target organization, making detection of this behavior difficult. Detection efforts may be focused on related stages of the adversary lifecycle, such as during Defense Evasion or Command and Control.

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